incorporated into India.'[92] The Chinese had nonetheless persisted with the idea until the fourth round. By then, it was clear that, despite the defeat of 1962 and the passage of nearly two decades, Delhi continued to reject the swap. India insisted on the sector-by-sector, all-or-nothing approach – perhaps there was more to be gained for China by going along. As Garver notes, 'if concessions in one area were no longer to be linked to gains in some other area [as in the swap], it made the most sense to push for the maximum in all sectors'.[93]

Garver also suggests that since Rao had rejected the notion that China was making a concession in the east, Beijing may well have concluded that Delhi needed reminding that China still maintained a strong claim in the eastern sector. Whatever India might think, in Chinese thinking giving up its claims in the eastern sector *was* a concession. Yet another possibility, according to Garver, is that the Chinese negotiators responded to a growing view that China should adopt a harder position in the discussions.[94] China was no longer weak as it had been in 1960, the region south of the McMahon Line was rich in timber, hydroelectricity, and minerals (one-third of the resources 'of all of Tibet') and had prime agricultural land. The eastern claim was therefore more important than Aksai Chin, which had no natural resources and was no longer logistically that important (since Tibet had been brought under control and was serviced by alternative routes).[95]

Finally, the Indian diplomat Ranjit Singh Kalha suggests that the Chinese may have concluded that if they conceded in the eastern sector, India would press even harder in the west. They may have decided therefore to scuttle the talks on the border and turn discussion to other issues such as normalization. In any case, they may have calculated that Rajiv Gandhi did not have the political strength at home to come to a final settlement.[96]

India's rejection of the swap clearly played a role in China's abandoning the idea and hardening its stand on the border. Garver reconstructs Chinese thinking after both the 1960 and 1980 offers were rejected:

> It is difficult to overstate the impact on informed Chinese opinion of India's two-fold rejection [1960 and 1980] of China's east-west swap proposal . . . By rejecting China's reasonable proposal, India demonstrated once again, its arrogant attitude: what's mine is mine, and what's